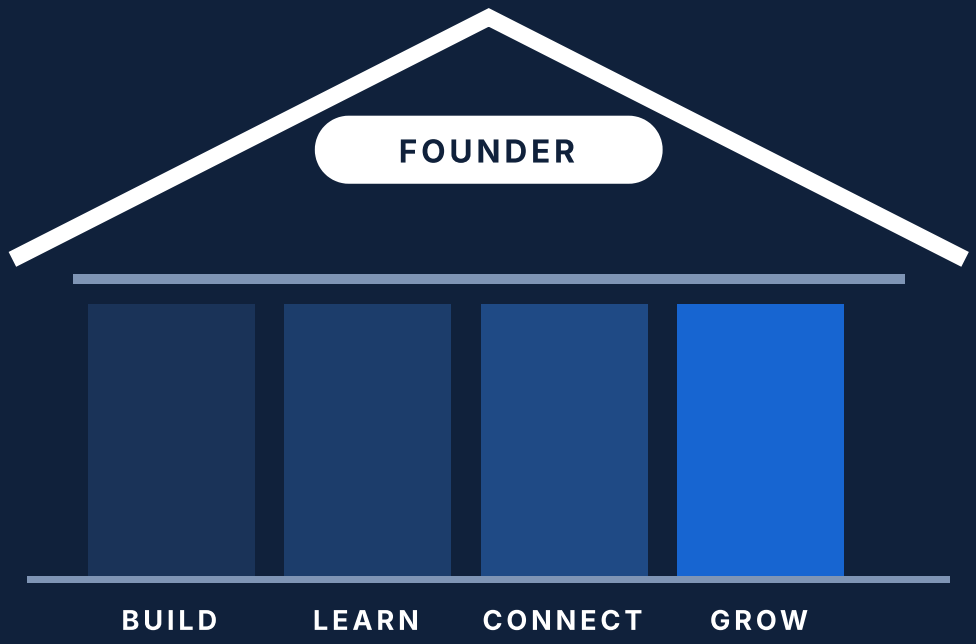
STARTUP ROOF



A FOUNDER ECOSYSTEM · UAE FIRST, GLOBAL AMBITION

STARTUP ROOF

A year-round ecosystem to help founders build, learn, connect and grow.

Home of Founder OS — the digital workspace for the founder journey.

startuproof.com

Founders need more than information. They need a practical path forward.

Starting a business has never had more advice available — and it can still feel hard to know what to do next. Startup Roof is being developed to connect practical guidance, useful tools and the right people around a founder, so each step forward is clearer.

WHAT FOUNDERS OFTEN FACE

01 Information is scattered

Guidance sits across many websites, groups and programmes.

02 Tools do not connect

Plans, tasks and contacts live in separate apps.

03 Advice lacks a next step

General advice rarely becomes “what do I do this week?”

04 The right people are hard to find

Mentors and specialists are reached by chance, not fit.

05 Introductions go nowhere

Few connections lead to a conversation with a useful outcome.

06 Time and money are limited

Every hour and every dirham has to count.

OUR PURPOSE

Startup Roof brings practical guidance, useful tools and meaningful connections together to help founders take their next step.

These challenges are our starting hypotheses. We are testing them directly with founders through interviews, sessions and follow-up before scaling anything.

FOUR THINGS FOUNDERS NEED

Build | Learn | Connect | Grow

> **An ecosystem around the founder.**
> **A digital workspace for the journey.**

HOW WE APPROACH IT

Practical by design

Every session, resource and introduction should end with a clear next step for the founder.

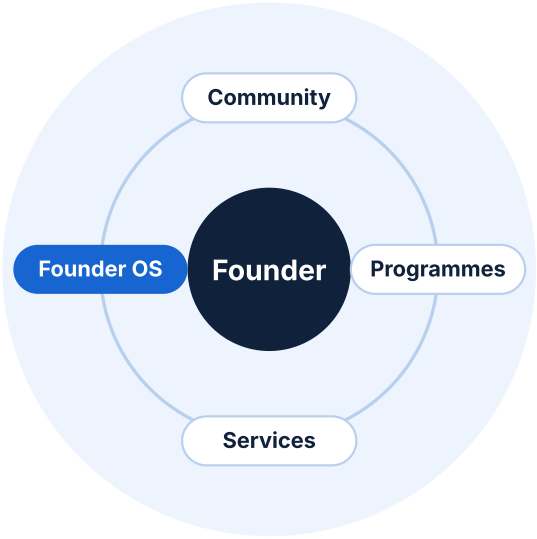
Open to many sectors

Technology startups and commercially viable consumer, wellness, retail and service businesses.

Tested before scaled

Currently shaping the platform and testing the founder experience through an initial collaboration and pilot phase.

One ecosystem around the founder.



STARTUP ROOF = the wider ecosystem

The community, programmes, relationships and services around a founder all year — online and in person.

FOUNDER OS = the digital workspace

The guided online experience inside the ecosystem: a founder's profile, goals, next steps, resources and connections in one place.

Startup Roof begins with a UAE focus and has a global ambition. It is designed for technology startups *and* commercially viable businesses in sectors such as consumer products, wellness, retail and services. Not every business needs venture funding, and many grow from their own revenue.

WHO IT IS FOR — AND WHY THEY TAKE PART

AUDIENCE	WHAT THEY GAIN
Aspiring entrepreneurs	A clear place to test an idea and understand where to start.
Early-stage founders	Validation, structure, feedback and help reaching first customers.
Founders seeking growth	Operational support, specialists and sharper go-to-market.
Mentors and specialists	A structured way to share experience with founders who fit their expertise.
Investors and angels	Engagement with better-prepared founders in sectors of interest.
Universities and incubators	Continued support for student and alumni founders beyond one programme.
Corporate innovation teams	Contact with early ventures through practical challenges and pilots.
Technology and service providers	A relevant route to founders who need their tools and services.

Every founder starts somewhere different.

Founders join at different stages and follow different paths. The journey below is a guide, not a fixed sequence.

STAGE	COMMON FOUNDER QUESTION	USEFUL NEXT ACTION
Explore	Is this idea worth pursuing?	Write down the problem and who has it.
Validate	Will people actually pay for this?	Speak to 10–20 potential customers.
Build	What is the simplest version to offer?	Define a first offer and test it.
Launch	How do I reach my first customers?	Run one focused acquisition test.
Grow	How do I grow without breaking things?	Fix the biggest operational bottleneck.
Prepare for capital	Should I raise — and am I ready?	Decide whether external funding fits. Only where appropriate.

Founder OS: the digital workspace

PLANNED CAPABILITY

1 My startup

Founder profile, stage and goals, personal dashboard.

2 Next steps

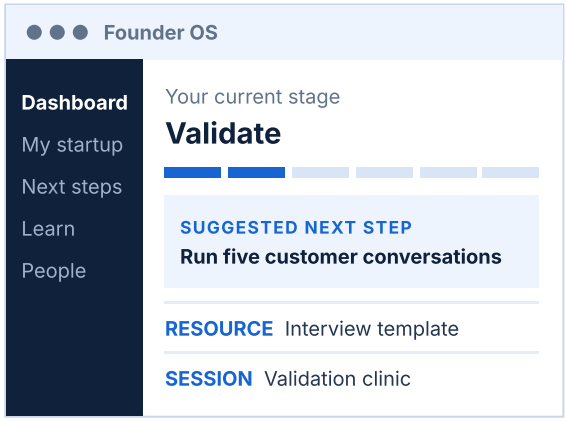
Tasks, resources and templates, learning progress.

3 People and support

Mentor and specialist discovery, connection and service requests.

4 Opportunities and progress

Relevant opportunities, activity and progress tracking.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

PROPOSED APPROACH

Digital guidance, strengthened by human experience.

AI can help founders organise their thinking and keep momentum. People bring judgement, sector experience and accountability. Startup Roof is designed to combine both — and to leave decisions with the founder.

AI-ASSISTED SUPPORT	HUMAN SUPPORT
Organising information	Mentoring
Helping founders explore questions	Specialist judgement
Drafting plans	Practical feedback
Suggesting resources	Complex business decisions
Tracking next steps	Sector expertise

> **AI prepares, people judge, founders decide.** AI features will be tested with pilot founders before release; none is described here as live.

How the experience is designed to work

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

A first-time founder in Dubai wants to launch a healthy-snack brand. The recipe is ready, but there is no evidence yet that customers will buy.

1. **Complete a profile**
   Stage, sector, goals and time available.
2. **Identify the challenge**
   “I don’t know if anyone will pay for this.”
3. **Get a relevant next step**
   An interview guide and a short validation task.
4. **Attend a clinic or ask for help**
   A group validation clinic or a mentor request.
5. **Record progress**
   Notes from customer conversations and pricing feedback.
6. **Return for the next step**
   Move on to testing a first offer.

An example of the intended experience — not a real customer case.

Relevant people, practical learning and the right specialist.

Community and meaningful connections

Founder introductions, peer groups, office hours, mentor sessions, small gatherings, community discussions and accountability check-ins. We will judge success by completed, useful interactions — not directory size.

Request	Consent	Introduction	Conversation	Follow-up	Outcome noted

Product principles: consent from both sides before any introduction, and founder-controlled profile visibility.

Founder Academy

PROPOSED THEMES

Every session follows a simple loop: **Learn → Apply → Receive feedback → Take the next action.**

- Idea validation
- Business models
- AI and automation
- Go-to-market and customer acquisition
- Pricing and unit economics
- Pitch readiness
- Legal and operational foundations
- Consumer-brand and retail development

No course catalogue exists yet; sessions will be shaped with founders and contributors during the pilot.

Expert services and partner tools

Potential categories: legal · accounting and finance · branding and design · technology and automation · marketing and sales · customer communication · business setup · product and retail guidance.

Expert sessions

Clinics and one-to-one time with experienced practitioners.

Partner-provided services

Defined packages from vetted providers, scoped up front.

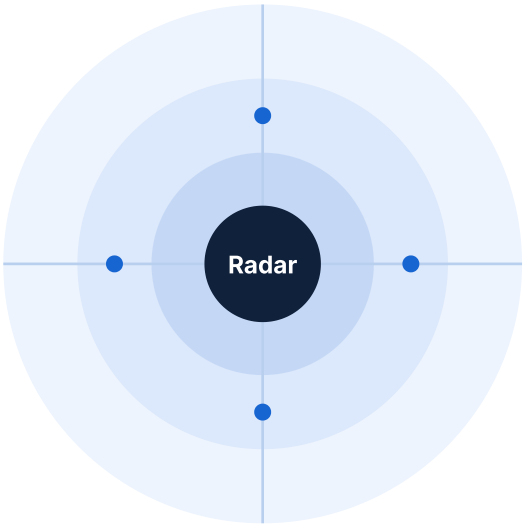
Integrated tools

Useful software inside Founder OS, or white-label, where commercial rights allow.

Packages, providers, integrations and fulfilment will be validated during the pilot. No supplier is presented as a confirmed partner.

What matters to a founder this week — with context.

Founders lose time searching for updates, events and calls for applications that may not apply to them. Startup Roof plans to curate what is relevant and explain why it matters.



Startup Roof Radar PLANNED

A curated view of startup updates, relevant events, and funding and programme opportunities — starting with the UAE and widening over time.

Founder interviews and media

Conversations with founders and practitioners that share practical lessons: what they tried, what worked and what they would do differently.

EDITORIAL PRINCIPLES

PRINCIPLE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Relevance	Filtered by a founder's stage, sector and location.
Attribution	Every item credits and links to its original source.
Freshness	Items are dated and removed when no longer current.
Founder context	A short note on why it matters and what to do next.

UAE FIRST, GLOBAL AMBITION

Coverage will start with the UAE, where the project is based, and extend to other markets as the community grows. It will be selective and grow step by step — not a complete news service.

Selective, structured support — and better-prepared founders.

A proposed incubation pathway

Intensive support is selective. Places depend on fit, the founder's commitment and Startup Roof's delivery capacity, and terms are agreed separately with each business.

1. **Understand needs**
2. **Assess suitability**
3. **Define a support plan**
4. **Match mentors**
5. **Agree milestones**
6. **Review progress**

EXAMPLE PLAN	TECHNOLOGY STARTUP	CONSUMER OR SERVICE BUSINESS
Typical focus	Product–market fit, early traction, technical choices	Unit economics, channels, supply and operations
Example milestone	First ten paying customers on a defined plan	Margin-positive pilot with one retail or online channel
Typical specialists	Product, AI and automation, go-to-market	Brand, retail, sourcing, finance

Value for investors

Better founder preparation, more structured startup information shared with consent, relevant discovery by sector and stage, sector-specific sessions, more useful introductions and ongoing relationships with the ecosystem.

STARTUP ROOF AIMS TO	STARTUP ROOF DOES NOT
Help founders become investor-ready	Operate its own investment fund today
Make relevant, consented introductions	Promise deal flow, exclusivity or returns
Host sector sessions with investors	Assume every founder should raise capital

Any future investment activity would require its own structure, approvals and terms.

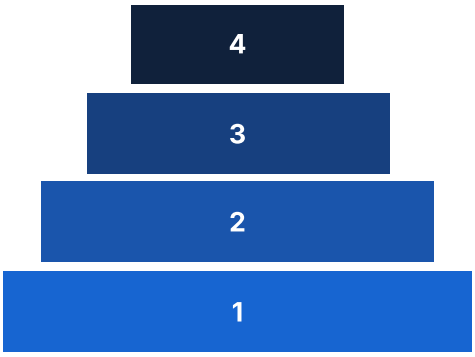
Free access can create reach. Useful services must create sustainable value.

Collaborating with ecosystem partners

Universities, incubators, corporates, professional firms and technology providers may take part to reach relevant founders, deliver education or specialist support, test services, support entrepreneurship programmes and explore commercial distribution.

- Workshops
- Office hours
- University programmes
- Tool or service pilots
- Community activities
- Content collaboration

These are possible formats to explore together; no partnerships are presented as signed.



Four layers of the proposed model PROPOSED

4 · Investment connections and future pathways — readiness and relevant introductions.

3 · Selective incubation — deeper support on separately agreed terms.

2 · Paid tools and support — deeper tools, specialist sessions, programmes.

1 · Free founder access — community, selected resources, discovery.

Revenue hypotheses to test

- Paid memberships or tools
- Specialist support packages
- Structured programmes
- Partner and service revenue arrangements
- Corporate or university programmes
- Sponsorship of suitable activities
- Selective incubation, where separately agreed

What the pilot must show

Free access builds reach and trust. Optional paid value must be clearly useful. Delivery costs — expert time, platform, events — are real. Each service's unit economics will be validated before any pricing or forecast is published.

Shape, test, then expand what works.

Where we are: currently shaping the platform and testing the founder experience through an initial collaboration and pilot phase.

NOW

Shape and test

Founder interviews, participant contributions, service selection and platform requirements.

NEXT

Deliver a small pilot

Useful sessions, onboarding, follow-up, growth experiments and measurement of delivery costs.

THEN

Expand what works

Repeat strong services, improve the platform, formalise responsibilities and build partnerships.

MILESTONES WE ARE WORKING TOWARDS

10,000
free users
Threshold for a public launch event.

March 2027
tentative
Target timing, subject to readiness.

100,000
free users
Wider, longer-term ambition.

> **Targets and timing will be refined through the pilot.** These are ambitions and milestones, not current traction.

WHAT THE PILOT WILL HELP US LEARN

- Founder needs
- Useful services
- Platform requirements
- Partner opportunities
- Contribution models
- Delivery capacity
- Sustainable commercial models

Bringing complementary experience together.

We are exploring how like-minded contributors can participate through their experience, resources and available time. A group of interested participants is already helping to shape the concept.

STRATEGY AND COMMERCIAL

- Commercial leadership
- GTM and customer lifecycle
- Legal and governance

FOUNDER SUPPORT

- Startup and incubation experience
- Consumer-business mentoring
- Education and university outreach

PLATFORM AND GROWTH

- AI and business systems
- Branding and growth

COMMUNITY AND DELIVERY

- Operations and community
- Events and experiences

How roles will take shape

Everyone involved can contribute in a role that suits them. Longer-term roles and responsibilities will be considered as the project develops, based on:

- Actual contribution
- Time commitment
- Responsibility taken
- Reliable delivery
- Value created

WAYS TO CONTRIBUTE NOW

Join founder interviews · run a session · review platform ideas · introduce a relevant organisation · help plan the pilot.

Ritesh Kumar
Project Initiator

11 · INVITATION TO PARTICIPATE

Help shape a practical ecosystem for the founder journey.

Founders	Help shape the platform and express interest in the pilot.
Mentors and specialists	Contribute expertise and practical sessions.
Partners and universities	Explore a useful collaboration.
Investors	Connect around founder readiness and ecosystem opportunities.
Prospective collaborators	Discuss how your skills and time can contribute.

startuproof.com

Scan the code or visit the website to get in touch.

STARTUP ROOF

An ecosystem around the founder. A digital workspace for the journey.